

CAMBERWOOD CHILDREN'S HOSPITAL
SOCIAL WORK DEPARTMENT · CASE NOTE

Re: BYRNE, Thomas (UR 4471902), 8y
Date: 20/03/1998
Author: Marta Kowalczyk, Senior Social Worker

Background

Referred by ward nursing staff following a disclosure during admission.

Notification

A notification was received on 18/03/1998 concerning Thomas's welfare during contact visits. The notifier has asked that their identity not be disclosed to either parent and I have given that undertaking.

The notifier is the Year 4 teacher at St Brendan's Primary who supervises the Tuesday afternoon swimming group Thomas attends, and who was the person who drove him home on 17/03.

Information from the mother

Sandra Byrne states that Gerald Byrne has attended three recent contact visits while intoxicated, and that on 17/03 he did not arrive at all. She states she has instructed a solicitor and intends to seek a variation of the current orders. She asked that this note not be shown to Gerald.

Information from the father

Gerald Byrne was contacted by telephone on 19/03. He denies the allegations and states that Sandra "is building a file". He declined a meeting.

Departmental involvement

A report has been made to the Department under the mandatory reporting provisions. Departmental file reference CP-1998-0332. Departmental staff advise their material is not to be released by this hospital.

Assessment and plan

Thomas presents as settled on the ward and did not raise concerns when seen alone. Writer's view is that the marital conflict, rather than the child's clinical condition, is driving the escalation, though this should not be recorded in terms that could inflame either parent.

Follow-up with the Department scheduled for 27/03/1998.

M. Kowalczyk